

Health Elective

Beta





About the Course

This course will provide the ½ credit health requirement for those states that require it or elective credit for any student (two terms of lessons). Approached within a Charlotte Mason framework of focusing on the whole personhood of the student, this course will explore nutrition, mental health, and physical well-being.



Placement & Combining Tips

May be suitable for Grade 9 students



Scheduling

GRADE	SCHEDULE INFO.	BOOKS
10-12	Health Elective (Beta) 3 times/week 45 min	A Simply Healthy Life Body into Balance: An Herbal Guide to Holistic Self-Care The Joy of Movement Eat Well and Feel Great

Sample Weekly View

Day 1	Day 2	Day 3	Day 4	Day 5
Health Elective (Beta)				
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Planning & Prep

Permission to print for non-commercial use. See Alveary group use policy to use lessons in a group context.

LINKS: Click text or scan the QR code in the top corner of the lesson plan pages to view online resources associated with the lessons.

Responsibility for previewing all links rests with the teacher. All links were checked at the time of publication; however, websites change frequently and may contain objectionable content. Please report broken links by contacting us through our website.

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☐ At the beginning of the year, students will need to set up a health notebook of some sort where they will record their personal takeaways after each reading session. A wellness journal is highly recommended but not required to help track each student's health journey. An optional link to purchase is included in the Quick Links.

☐ As you move through the book *Body into Balance*, make note of any of the recipes that Maria shares that you would like to attempt in Term 3. Keep a running list and order the supplies you'll need by the end of Term 2. Recommended herb suppliers include Mountain Rose Herbs and Starwest Botanicals.

Term Prep & Teacher Tips

Health Elective (Beta)

Term 2: Look through the Quick Link options or choose your own plan to reach your Intentional Fitness Goal by the end of the term.



Books & Resources

For book rationales and purchase options, click the Book List link or scan the QR code below.

∞ [View Book List Details](#)

Health Elective (Beta)



A Simply Healthy Life



Body into Balance: An Herbal Guide to Holistic Self-Care



The Joy of Movement



Eat Well and Feel Great



Supplies

For supply list details and basic supplies helpful to have on hand, click the links or scan the QR code below.

∞ [View Basic Supplies](#)

(No Subject Supplies Assigned)



Quick Links

Health Elective (Beta)

- ∞ [Wellness Journal \(Optional\)](#)
- ∞ [Couch to 5K Plan Option 1](#)
- ∞ [Couch to 5K Plan Option 2](#)
- ∞ [Weight Lift Training Guide Option 1](#)
- ∞ [Weight Lift Training Guide Option 2](#)

Click THIS text
or scan the QR
code for links.



Health Elective (Beta)

How To Approach



Read

The lesson plans will guide you through what to read or watch over the terms. Take a moment before reading/watching to remember where you left off last time.



Narrate

The lesson plans will give you specific instructions or tell you to choose a way to narrate that helps you interact with the ideas.



Discuss

The lesson plans will guide you with questions or instructions to share your ideas or what you are reading with others.



Teacher Note

These lessons are written directly to students, but to assist them throughout the year, please read through this section and the lesson plans so you are familiar with the instructions and flow of the lessons. Accountability components are occasionally added to facilitate teacher/student discussion and growing independence.

It is also valuable for those in a classroom setting to have a mix of lessons that students complete themselves silently and others read aloud and narrate together. These lessons lend themselves well to a larger discussion time at the end of the lesson where students can share their ideas.

Health Elective (Beta)

[Click THIS text or scan the QR code for links.](#)



Term 1

WEEK 1 45m Health Elective (Beta) - Lesson 1

Materials: Video links

→ INTRO

Throughout this course, you'll explore a wide range of ideas about health, from traditional medicine to herbal remedies and holistic care. You'll hear a variety of ideas, think critically about them, and decide what makes sense based on evidence and experience. The goal isn't to all think the same way, but to engage thoughtfully, ask good questions, and learn how to make wise, informed choices.

The video in these first two lessons challenges traditional medicine as the only route to health. While Alveary does not advocate the specific stances taken or the books the speakers wrote, it is an interesting opening to discuss the role of cell health, diet, lifestyle, metabolic differences, inflammation, etc., as factors in our long-term health.

During the first lesson each week, after watching the videos or reading the articles assigned, write a narration and include your takeaways. (How will you apply what you learned to your health journey?)

→ VIEW

∞ Video Link: What is Health? (Stop at 2:00.)

→ LISTEN & NARRATE

Listen to the first twenty minutes, record your takeaways, and discuss the following questions:

- How does this conversation differ from other thoughts you've heard on this subject?
- What parts do you agree or disagree with?
- What is the balance between the roles of traditional medicine and holistic medicine?

∞ Video Link: Dr. Josh Axe: Is the Healthcare System Designed to Keep You Sick? (51:56)

WEEK 1 45m Health Elective (Beta) - Lesson 2

Materials: A Simply Healthy Life

→ INTRO

During the second lesson each week, after reading the assignment for A Simply Healthy Life, write a narration and include your takeaways. (How will you apply what you learned to your health journey?) Each chapter presents challenges to help you on your health journey. You won't be able to do one each week, but I highly encourage you to choose one to complete and journal your results at some point in the term.

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

Ch.1 "Changing Your Life for Good"

- Notice the quotes at the beginning of each chapter...do any resonate with you? Consider adding them to your commonplace book.
- Do you have a goal you're working towards? If you do, complete the High-Yield Habit Exercise (write this in your health notebook). If you don't have a big goal you're working towards right now, choose 1 of the Habit Challenges to complete. Keep track of your habit over the next term with a habit tracker that you can put into your health journal (this can be as simple or as complicated as you want ... just search "habit trackers" to see some examples...there are even free apps to track your habits!).

Health Elective (Beta)

[Click THIS text or scan the QR code for links.](#)



Term 1

WEEK 1 45m Health Elective (Beta) - Lesson 3

Materials: Body Into Balance

→ INTRO

The third lesson each week will include additional reflection questions to help you make connections between the material you read/watch and your health journey. We will also use the third lesson each week to cover the book *Body Into Balance*, where you'll be introduced to herbal medicine. Looking for additional herbal resource books? Consider Rosemary Gladstar's *Medicinal Herbs: A Beginner's Guide*, or Rosalee de la Foret's *Alchemy of Herbs*. Looking for a historically scientific peek into American herbal medicine? Consider *American Eden: David Hosack, Botany, and Medicine in the Garden of the Early Republic* by Victoria Johnson.

→ NOTEBOOK

What's your definition of health? What is one bad habit you'd like to break? Is there a good habit you could replace the bad habit with that would fulfill the same reward or desire?

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

Introduction

- Add the 4 Safety Rules for Using Herbs to your health notebook.

WEEK 2 45m Health Elective (Beta) - Lesson 4

Materials: Video link

→ LISTEN & NARRATE

Listen to the rest of the session, record your takeaways, and continue to discuss the following questions:

- How does this conversation differ from other thoughts you've heard on this subject?
 - What parts do you agree or disagree with?
 - What is the balance between the roles of traditional medicine and holistic medicine?
- ∞ Video Link: Dr. Josh Axe: Is the Healthcare System Designed to Keep You Sick? (51:56)

WEEK 2 45m Health Elective (Beta) - Lesson 5

Materials: A Simply Healthy Life

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

Ch.3 "Move Hard, Sleep Hard"

- Consider choosing a Move Hard, Sleep Hard Challenge. Be sure to journal your journey in your health notebook.

WEEK 2 45m Health Elective (Beta) - Lesson 6

Materials: Body Into Balance

→ NOTEBOOK

Tell about some of the ways Dr. Casey Means gives on how to build good energy in your cells. How do you rate your sleep on a scale of 1 to 10 (1 being very little sleep and 10 being fully rested)? What are some ways you can improve your sleep hygiene?

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

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[Click THIS text or scan the QR code for links.](#)



Term 1

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- Describe the foundations of good health.

WEEK 3 45m Health Elective (Beta) - Lesson 7

Materials: Audio link

→ LISTEN & NARRATE

∞ Audio Link: Wellness Mama Podcast: Your Brain on Food (25:19)

→ NOTE

A transcript is also available if you have trouble understanding anything Dr. Naidoo says.

WEEK 3 45m Health Elective (Beta) - Lesson 8

Materials: A Simply Healthy Life

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

Ch.4 "The Path to Optimal Functioning"

- Consider choosing a Detox Challenge, and be sure to journal about it in your health notebook.

WEEK 3 45m Health Elective (Beta) - Lesson 9

Materials: Body Into Balance

→ NOTEBOOK

How does food impact our mental health?

→ ACTIVITY

Take inventory of your personal care products. Which ones might you choose to investigate or gradually swap out? Come up with a plan!

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

p.31

As we now get into specific herbs, you may either choose to read about all of the herbs presented, or you may choose one herb to read more about.

The assignments all assume that you're going to choose one to learn more about, but don't limit yourself! You also will not be assigned the reading on Protocol Points, but if you see something that applies to your health journey, feel free to follow that detour!

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

Choose one nutritive herb (p.33-41) to read about and record what you learned in your health notebook. (You can even treat this assignment as a nature study reflection...draw the plant, label it, and record what it can be used for.)